

Russell Dudek

AI Operations and Business Transformation Leader

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https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes. Direct AI workflow design and governance work combined with transformation leadership, training, quality systems, and high-consequence execution.

ROLE-ALIGNED CAPABILITIES

AI operations strategy · LLM and agentic workflows · Automation opportunity assessment · Human-in-the-loop design · Evaluation and governance · Training and enablement · Communities of practice · Cross-functional transformation · Executive communication · Lean/Gemba systems

VAPE-JET — Director of Operations | 2025-Present

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works directly in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing operating feedback loops.

DUDEWORTH — Founder / AI and Automation Advisor | 2017-Present

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks assessing value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

AMAZON — Operations Management / Site Leader | 2014-2018

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms; applied Lean and Gemba practices.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and contributed to Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

DIRECT FIT FOR ONTRA

Hands-on AI Workflow, LLM, agentic, human-review and evaluation patterns	Capability building Training, standard work, advocates, technical programming and operating cadence
Governed execution Quality systems, decision records, escalation, controls and high-consequence work	Enterprise translation Connects operations, technical teams, customers, leaders, vendors and systems

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COMPUNETICS — Director of Operations and Engineering Management | 2000-2013

- Progressed through R&D; program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

CARDINAL BUILDING PRODUCTS — Regional Director | 2021-2023

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows; advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZEUSVU — Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations | 2018-2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.

ENVIRO SOCIAL CAPITAL — Chairman of the Board | 2014-2017

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE — CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair | 2012-2016

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.
- Organized conferences, seminars, business tours, and technical programming.

EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & TOOLKIT

University of Pittsburgh — Bachelor of Science. Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

Selected credentials: Google AI Essentials · IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner · Six Sigma Certification

Toolkit: Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG patterns · Human-in-the-loop design · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · ERP/Odoo · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack · GIS and mapping workflows